

100 million

Samsung's App-store has crossed the 100 million apps download mark

OMG, LOL in OED

Oxford English Dictionary has added the terms OMG and LOL to its latest edition

Buzz

Apple's next-gen MacBook Pro family announced in India, prices slashed

Apple has introduced the new MacBook Pro family, featuring some sparkling new tech and significantly different specs from the previous generation, but remaining much the same on the outside. There are five models split between the three sizes – two 13-inch and 15-inch MacBook Pros, and one 17-inch MacBook Pro – and all of them will feature Intel's Sandy Bridge chips, in Core i5 and i7 variants. Pricing is much lower than last years, with the base model costing Rs. 69,990.

The MacBook Pro family also introduces Intel's first iteration of Light Peak tech-



nology, the dual-channel I/O 'Thunderbolt', which promises up to 10Gbps bi-directional transfer speeds. Read more on Thunderbolt, here. But while MacBook Pro notebooks are available with Thunderbolt right now, devices supporting them will only arrive in the latter part of the year. Many major storage manufacturers however, have vowed support for both Thunderbolt and

other future Light Peak technologies.

All the MacBook Pro laptops also ship with a FireWire 800 port on board, while the 17-inch model has an ExpressCard/34 slot instead of a SDXC card slot.

Apple's latest generation of MacBook Pro laptops differ from last in two other major aspects – they feature AMD Mobility Radeon

graphics (6000M) instead of Nvidia's offerings, and, have new FaceTime HD cameras for video-chat, which offer 3 times the resolution as their iSight predecessors, promising full HD video conferencing. FaceTime for Mac has also been released, available for 99 cents on the Mac Store. All the laptops feature LED-backlit screens, with a choice of glossy or anti-glare coating (not in 13-inch models). The 15-inch models also come with a choice of 1680x1050 high-resolutions screens, instead of the 1440x900 default.

Importantly, the 13-inch MacBook Pro models do not feature discrete graphics, but apparently, Apple and Intel are confident the Sandy Bridge assisted Intel HD 3000 graphics will be up to the challenge. ■

Microsoft releases Windows 7 SP1

Microsoft has released Windows 7 Service Pack 1, which is now available for download via the Microsoft Download Center, and, via Windows Update of course.

Microsoft said in a blog post: "It does, however, include client-side support for RemoteFX and Dynamic Memory which are two new virtualization features enabled in Windows Server 2008 R2 SP1."

Dynamic Memory will allow Windows Server Hyper-V administrators to increase their virtual machine's density, without having to sacrifice performance or security. RemoteFX will allow for the virtualization of the Graphical Processing Unit on the server side to deliver next-generation rich media and 3D user experiences for Virtual Desktop Infrastructures. ■

Google Cloud Connect improves MS Office collaboration, for a 'nominal fee'

First there was the Microsoft add-on for H.264 on Chrome, and now, this – Google has taught "your old docs new tricks" with the Google Cloud Connect for Microsoft Office, enabling real-time collaboration of documents, spreadsheets, presentation just like Google Docs, except now, it is for Microsoft Word, Excel, and PowerPoint.

Compatible with everything from Office 2003 to Office 2010, Google Cloud Connect is certainly a cheeky way of leveraging the best aspect (real-time web-based collaboration) of Google Docs, onto Microsoft's comprehensive and powerful productivity suite.

Calling it "multi-person, simultaneous editing," the post

enumerated the benefits of Google Cloud Connect's "web-powered collaboration within traditional software." Google is looking to leverage the service at those enterprises who use varying and aging versions of Microsoft Office, and offering everyone a global '90-Day App-sperience' program to try and see for themselves at a nominal

fee, before they purchase a \$50 a year, per user license.

Simultaneously, a new collaboration dashboard is being launched as well, to help companies measure the productivity of the new framework better. Google Cloud Connect, as well as the new dashboard, are available in English now, and will be available in more languages soon. ■



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